



HOW TO MAKE A GLASS TERRARIUM

Materials

- * Clear glass container with lid or dome, such as a hurricane lamp, preserving jar, bell cloche, or cake cover
- * Gravel or small pebbles
- * Small compost scoop or spoon
- * Activated carbon granules
- * John Innes No. 2 potting compost
- * Dibber, chopstick, or pencil
- * Bonsai or ordinary tweezers
- * Water mister



Plant list

- * Carpet moss
- * *Dionaea muscipula*
- * *Hosta* 'Blue Mouse Ears'
- * *Hosta* 'Cracker Crumbs'
- * *Hosta* 'Iced Lemon'
- * *Nepenthes x ventrata*
- * *Scleranthus uniflorus*
- * *Utricularia sandersonii*



1 Choose a transparent container and lid appropriate to the size of your plants, with room for the planting medium and growing. Terrariums have no drainage holes so, to keep roots from rotting, it is vital to include a generous layer of gravel for excess water to collect.



2 Use a spoon to sprinkle a thin layer of activated carbon granules (available from aquatic suppliers) over the gravel. This will help to keep the container smelling sweet by filtering out impurities. Wash the carbon granules first to remove any residue.



3 Next, add some planting medium. What you put in depends on the plants you choose, but a peat-like compost that retains moisture and allows drainage is a good choice. Add a layer of the compost and lightly pat down with a dibber, chopstick, or pencil.



4 Get your plants ready for planting by removing any loose soil and gently teasing any pot-bound roots. Make a small depression in the compost, then carefully position your plant in the soil.